


# Constitution and Bylaws

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# Geospatial Science Student Association (GSSA) CONSTITUTION

## Article I: Name and Institutional Status

**1.1** The official name of the organization is the "Geospatial Science Student Association at Saint Louis University."

**1.2** The organization may be referred to as the "Geospatial Science Student Association" or "GSSA."

**1.3** GSSA is a student-led Recognized Student Organization (RSO) sponsored by the Geospatial Center at Saint Louis University.

**1.4** GSSA operates student activities in alignment and compliance with the Saint Louis University Student Handbook. The Geospatial Center and Faculty Advisor provide guidance, financial support, and institutional continuity but do not control student votes or elections.

**1.5** GSSA shall comply with Saint Louis University policies and applicable law. If this Constitution or the Bylaws conflict with controlling University policy, the University policy governs, and the remaining provisions continue in effect.

**1.6** GSSA, including its officers, members, and committees, may not legally bind Saint Louis University or the Geospatial Center, enter into contracts or agreements on their behalf, incur obligations on their behalf, or use University marks except through an authorized University process.

## Article II: Mission and Objectives

**2.1** GSSA advances the understanding and application of geospatial science and technology. It gives students opportunities to strengthen technical skills, pursue professional development, and connect with practitioners in government, industry, academia, and the broader community.

**2.2** GSSA pursues the following objectives:

(a) Provide hands-on learning in geographic information systems, remote sensing, GeoAI, cartography, spatial data science, and related technologies.

(b) Increase awareness of geospatial science among undergraduate and graduate students at Saint Louis University and within the St. Louis community.

(c) Connect students with mentors, employers, professional societies, researchers, public agencies, and community partners.

(d) Encourage interdisciplinary collaboration, peer learning, research exchange, and responsible use of geospatial technologies.

(e) Support educational, professional, public-interest, and community-engaged applications of geospatial science.

(f) Build an inclusive community that supports students entering geospatial programs and careers.

**2.3** GSSA may advance these objectives through meetings, GeoHours, workshops, guest speakers, professional development, conferences, outreach, service, field activities, collaborative projects, and other programs approved under the Bylaws.

**Article III: Membership**

**3.1** Any undergraduate or graduate student currently enrolled at Saint Louis University may become a Student Member by completing the official GSSA membership form.

**3.2** GSSA membership is free for Saint Louis University students. GSSA shall not charge membership dues.

**3.3** A Student Member becomes an Active Member by attending at least two GSSA meetings or events during the current semester. Only Active Members may vote or run for elected office.

**3.4** Student Members may attend meetings and programs, submit proposals, serve on committees, and receive fair consideration for GSSA opportunities. Active Members also have the right to vote and seek office if they meet all other eligibility requirements.

**3.5** Faculty, staff, alumni, practitioners, students from other institutions, and other supporters may participate as Affiliate Members when invited or accepted by the Executive Board. Affiliate Members may advise and participate but may not vote or hold elected office.

**3.6** GSSA shall administer membership, leadership, programs, and opportunities in accordance with Saint Louis University's nondiscrimination, equal-opportunity, and accessibility policies.

**3.7** Membership ends when a student is no longer enrolled, resigns in writing, or is no longer eligible under University policy. Graduation does not prevent participation as an Affiliate Member.

**Article IV: Authority of Student Members**

**4.1** GSSA derives its student-governance authority from its Student Members, subject to Saint Louis University policy.

**4.2** Active Members elect officers and make final decisions on amendments to the Constitution or Bylaws, ratification, and dissolution. The Executive Board may remove an officer in accordance with the procedures established in the Bylaws.

**4.3** The Executive Board manages routine operations, programs, finances, communications, partnerships, and University requirements. Routine Board decisions

do not require approval by the full membership unless this Constitution or the Bylaws state otherwise.

**4.4** Each Active Member has one vote. No officer, member, advisor, academic unit, sponsor, or partner receives additional voting authority.

**4.5** The Bylaws may provide detailed procedures but may not reduce a power or right reserved to Active Members by this Constitution.

## Article V: Executive Board

**5.1** The Executive Board consists of four elected officers:

(a) President.

(b) Secretary.

(c) Vice President of Finance.

(d) Vice President of Communications.

**5.2** The President must be a graduate student. At least three of the four Executive Board officers must be graduate students.

**5.3** An officer must be an enrolled Saint Louis University student, an Active Member, and in good academic and disciplinary standing. An individual may hold only one elected GSSA office at a time.

**5.4** Regular terms last one year, beginning May 1 and ending April 30. An officer may serve no more than two consecutive full terms in the same office.

**5.5** The Executive Board is accountable to the membership and shall carry out the mission, protect GSSA resources, and comply with this Constitution, the Bylaws, and University requirements.

**5.6** Officers serve without compensation. They may receive reimbursement for approved GSSA expenses under the financial procedures in the Bylaws.

## Article VI: Faculty Advisor and Geospatial Center Affiliation

**6.1** Dr. Vasit Sagan shall serve as the founding Faculty Advisor. The Faculty Advisor is a non-voting advisor to GSSA and the Executive Board.

**6.2** The Faculty Advisor supports continuity, offers guidance, helps GSSA understand University requirements, and connects the organization with the Geospatial Center and other appropriate resources.

**6.3** GSSA is affiliated with the Geospatial Center. This affiliation supports collaboration, mentorship, visibility, and access to geospatial expertise while preserving student governance.

**6.4** A future Faculty Advisor may be appointed by a vote of at least three of the four Executive Board officers after consultation with the Geospatial Center. A change in advisor does not require an amendment to this Constitution.

**6.5** The Faculty Advisor may participate in meetings and discussions but may not vote. Advisor attendance is not required for quorum unless University policy requires the Advisor's presence for a specific action.

## Article VII: Amendments

**7.1** An Active Member or the Executive Board may propose an amendment to this Constitution.

**7.2** The complete proposed amendment and an explanation of its purpose must be distributed to Student Members at least fourteen calendar days before the vote.

**7.3** Student Members must have a reasonable opportunity to discuss the proposal before voting.

**7.4** An amendment is adopted by two-thirds of valid votes cast at a meeting or authorized electronic vote with the general-membership quorum required by the Bylaws.

**7.5** The Secretary shall record the adopted text, vote, certification date, and effective date in the official governing-document record.

## Article VIII: Ratification

**8.1** The Founding Executive Board may adopt this Constitution and the Bylaws for provisional use by a vote of at least three of the four founding officers.

**8.2** Provisional adoption authorizes the Founding Executive Board to register GSSA, establish membership, conduct programs, manage formation activities, and organize the first member ratification.

**8.3** Active Members shall vote on ratification during GSSA's first full academic semester. Ratification requires two-thirds of valid votes cast with a general-membership quorum.

**8.4** The Constitution and Bylaws take full effect upon certification of the ratification vote.

## Article IX: Dissolution

**9.1** A proposal to dissolve GSSA must be distributed to Student Members at least fourteen calendar days before the vote and must explain the reason for dissolution.

**9.2** Dissolution requires two-thirds of valid votes cast with a general-membership quorum and any approval required by Saint Louis University.

**9.3** After GSSA satisfies its outstanding obligations, remaining funds, records, equipment, and other property shall be transferred to the Geospatial Center for future student geospatial programming, subject to University policy.

**9.4** No member, officer, advisor, or private person may receive GSSA assets for personal benefit.

# Geospatial Science Student Association (GSSA) BYLAWS

## Article I: Membership Administration

### Section 1: Membership Form and Roster

**1.1** A student joins GSSA by completing the current membership form. The Secretary shall maintain the official membership roster.

**1.2** The membership form shall request only information reasonably needed for membership, communication, accommodations, elections, or program administration.

### Section 2: Active Member Status

**1.3** The Secretary shall record attendance at GSSA meetings and events. A Student Member who attends at least two GSSA meetings or events during a semester is an Active Member for that semester.

**1.4** A Student Member may attain or regain Active Member status at any time during a semester by attending at least two GSSA meetings or events during that semester.

**1.5** Before a vote, the Secretary shall use the official membership and attendance records to identify eligible Active Members.

### Section 3: Member Participation

**1.6** Members are expected to treat others respectfully, follow event and University requirements, protect confidential information, and use GSSA resources responsibly.

**1.7** GSSA shall make reasonable efforts to provide accessible notices, meeting formats, and program information. Requests for accommodations shall be handled through appropriate University procedures.

## Article II: Executive Board Responsibilities

### Section 1: Collective Responsibilities

**2.1** The Executive Board shall:

(a) Set semester and annual priorities consistent with the GSSA mission.

(b) Approve programs, partnerships, budgets, expenditures, committees, and official organizational positions.

(c) Maintain University recognition and complete required training, forms, reports, and transitions.

(d) Seek input from members and communicate material decisions, opportunities, and governance changes.

(e) Protect GSSA funds, records, property, digital accounts, and reputation.

**Section 2: President**

**2.2** The President is responsible for:

(a) Providing overall leadership and coordinating GSSA's annual direction.

(b) Presiding over general membership and Executive Board meetings.

(c) Serving as GSSA's principal representative to the Geospatial Center, Faculty Advisor, University offices, and external partners.

(d) Coordinating the programming plan and monitoring progress on Board decisions.

(e) Ensuring that GSSA follows the Constitution, Bylaws, approved policies, and University requirements.

(f) Assigning responsibilities while respecting the authority and duties of the other officers.

**Section 3: Secretary**

**2.3** The Secretary is responsible for:

(a) Preparing meeting notices and agendas with the President and distributing approved minutes.

(b) Maintaining the membership roster, attendance records, governing documents, election records, correspondence, reports, and organizational archive.

(c) Recording motions, votes, recusals, officer attendance, committee appointments, and action items.

(d) Receiving official committee updates and preserving final committee records.

(e) Maintaining continuity records and transferring them to the succeeding Secretary.

**Section 4: Vice President of Finance**

**2.4** The Vice President of Finance is responsible for:

(a) Preparing the semester or annual budget with the President and Executive Board and share with the faculty advisor for final approval.

(b) Maintaining accurate records of revenues, expenditures, reimbursements, receipts, sponsorships, grants, and organizational property.

(c) Confirming that proposed expenses are authorized, documented, and consistent with University requirements.

(d) Providing a financial update at Board meetings and at least one financial summary each semester to members.

(e) Administering reimbursements and maintaining financial transition records.

(f) Supporting transparent procedures for limited financial benefits and funded opportunities.

**Section 5: Vice President of Communications**

**2.5** The Vice President of Communications is responsible for:

(a) Managing official email announcements, social media, newsletters, website content, and promotional materials.

(b) Publicizing meetings, workshops, GeoHours, guest speakers, elections, community events, and opportunities with adequate notice.

(c) Maintaining accurate public information and consistent GSSA branding.

(d) Coordinating outreach to students, academic units, partner organizations, and the St. Louis geospatial community.

(e) Documenting programs through approved photographs, summaries, and communications records.

(f) Working with the President on guest speakers, external relationships, and public announcements.

**Section 6: Delegation, Attendance, and Transition**

**2.6** Officers may delegate tasks to members or committees but remain responsible for the duties of their offices. Delegation does not transfer Board voting authority or control of GSSA assets.

**2.7** Three unexcused Executive Board meeting absences during one term may constitute grounds for removal. Academic obligations, illness, emergencies, and absences communicated in advance may be excused.

**2.8** Outgoing officers shall transfer records, financial documents, passwords, accounts, equipment, and other GSSA property to their successors within one month after their terms end.

**2.9** Executive Board officers are expected to maintain reasonable communication with fellow officers, attend scheduled meetings, and fulfill assigned responsibilities. Officers should ordinarily acknowledge official organizational communications within three business days and notify the President or Secretary when academic, professional, health, or personal circumstances prevent their participation.

**2.10** An officer who fails to respond to official organizational communications for fourteen consecutive calendar days, without prior notice or reasonable justification, may be subject to a formal performance review by the Executive Board.

**2.11** Following a performance review, the Executive Board may issue written notice identifying the concerns and providing a reasonable opportunity to respond and

improve. The officer shall ordinarily be given at least seven calendar days to respond, with reasonable flexibility for documented or communicated circumstances.

**2.12** If the officer fails to respond or demonstrate reasonable improvement, the Executive Board may initiate removal proceedings in accordance with Article VII, Sections 7.6–7.10.

**2.13** A formal performance review does not constitute removal from office. Any removal decision must follow the procedures established in Article VII.

## Article III: Meetings, Quorum, and Voting

### Section 1: Meeting Schedule

**3.1** GSSA shall hold at least one general membership meeting during each fall semester and at least one during each spring semester.

**3.2** The Executive Board shall meet at least monthly during the fall and spring semesters and at least once during the summer.

**3.3** Meetings may be held in person, virtually, or in a hybrid format. Authorized virtual and hybrid participation counts as attendance.

### Section 2: Notice

**3.4** General membership meetings require at least seven calendar days' notice.

**3.5** Executive Board meetings require at least forty-eight hours' notice. An urgent Board meeting may be called with at least twenty-four hours' notice when delay would materially harm GSSA operations, property, compliance, or a time-sensitive opportunity.

**3.6** Elections, officer-removal proceedings, amendments, ratification, and dissolution votes require at least fourteen calendar days' notice.

**3.7** A notice shall state the date, time, participation method, and principal business to be considered.

### Section 3: Quorum

**3.8** General-membership quorum is twenty percent of current Active Members or ten Active Members, whichever is fewer, but never fewer than four Active Members.

**3.9** Executive Board quorum is three of the four officers. If a position is vacant, all three remaining officers constitute quorum.

**3.10** A Board with fewer than three officers may take only actions needed to protect GSSA assets, preserve compliance, appoint an interim officer, or call a member vote.

### Section 4: Voting

**3.11** Each Executive Board officer, including the President, has one vote. A Board motion passes by a majority of votes cast when quorum is present. A tie means the motion fails.

**3.12** A general-membership motion passes by a majority of valid votes cast unless the Constitution or Bylaws require a higher threshold.

**3.13** Voting may occur at a meeting when all eligible voters receive the same information and a reasonable opportunity to participate.

**3.14** The Secretary shall record the motion, number eligible, number participating, result, and disclosed recusals. Secret-ballot choices shall remain confidential.

**Section 5: Minutes**

**3.15** The Secretary shall prepare minutes for general membership and Executive Board meetings. Minutes shall identify attendance, motions, votes, recusals, decisions, and assigned actions.

**3.16** Minutes shall be approved by the body that held the meeting or by a method that body previously authorized.

## Article IV: Programs, Committees, and Partnerships

**Section 1: Programs**

**4.1** The Executive Board may approve programs that advance GSSA's mission, including GeoHours, technical workshops, speakers, professional development, conferences, outreach, service, networking, and collaborative projects.

**4.2** The Board shall consider member interest, accessibility, available resources, safety, academic schedules, and University requirements when planning programs.

**Section 2: Temporary Committees and Project Teams**

**4.3** A Vice President may propose a temporary committee or project team when membership participation or the number and scale of planned events make additional support useful.

**4.4** A committee is established only after approval by at least three of the four Executive Board officers.

**4.5** The approving motion shall identify the sponsoring Vice President, purpose, scope, chair, expected duration, reporting schedule, and any approved budget or spending authority.

**4.6** The sponsoring Vice President may determine the number of students needed based on the size and requirements of the event or project and may recruit eligible Student Members to serve.

**4.7** A committee chair does not become an Executive Board member and does not receive an Executive Board vote.

**4.8** Once approved, a committee may carry out its assigned work independently within its approved scope and budget. It shall report operationally to the sponsoring Vice President and submit official updates and records to the Secretary.

**4.9** A committee may not commit unapproved funds, enter an agreement, change organizational policy, issue an official public position, or use GSSA accounts beyond the authority granted by the Board.

**4.10** A temporary committee ends when its assigned work is complete or when dissolved by at least three of the four Executive Board officers. Its final records shall be submitted to the Secretary.

### Section 3: Partnerships

**4.11** The Executive Board may approve collaboration with University units, student organizations, professional societies, government agencies, businesses, nonprofit organizations, and community groups.

**4.12** A partnership may not transfer control of GSSA elections, membership, finances, academic content, or student-selection decisions to an outside party.

## Article V: Elections, Terms, and Transition

### Section 1: Election Schedule and Administration

**5.1** Regular elections shall occur in March or April and shall be completed before May 1.

**5.2** The Executive Board shall appoint at least two non-candidate Active Members to administer the election. The Faculty Advisor or another neutral University representative may observe the process.

**5.3** Election administrators shall publish the schedule, confirm eligibility, receive nominations, prepare the ballot, resolve procedural questions, count votes, certify results, and preserve election records.

### Section 2: Nominations and Candidates

**5.4** Nominations shall remain open for at least fourteen calendar days.

**5.5** An eligible Active Member may nominate themselves or another eligible member with that person's consent.

**5.6** Each candidate may submit a brief statement for equal distribution to eligible voters.

**5.7** A candidate may seek only one Executive Board office in the same election.

**5.8** Before nominations open, election administrators shall identify whether any non-presidential office must be limited to graduate-student candidates to preserve the graduate-majority requirement.

### Section 3: Ballots and Results

**5.9** Voting shall occur by confidential ballot. Each eligible Active Member may cast one vote for each office.

**5.10** The candidate receiving the most valid votes for an office is elected.

**5.11** An uncontested candidate shall appear on an approval ballot and is elected only by a majority of valid votes cast. If the candidate does not receive majority approval, nominations reopen.

**5.12** A tie shall proceed to a confidential runoff between the tied candidates. If a second runoff remains tied, election administrators shall use a transparent random selection observed by the Faculty Advisor or another neutral witness.

**5.13** Aggregate results shall be announced promptly. Individual ballot choices shall remain confidential.

### Section 4: Terms and Transition

**5.14** Newly elected officers take office on May 1. The outgoing and incoming officers shall use the period between certification and May 1 for training and transition.

**5.15** A partial term filled through appointment or special election does not count as a full term for the two-term limit unless the person serves more than half of the regular term.

## Article VI: Resignations, Vacancies, and Succession

### Section 1: Resignation

**6.1** An officer may resign by written notice to the President and Secretary. The President shall submit a resignation to the Secretary and Faculty Advisor.

**6.2** The Executive Board shall notify Student Members of a resignation and vacancy within five business days.

### Section 2: Interim Appointment and Special Election

**6.3** The remaining Executive Board officers may appoint an eligible interim officer by majority vote to maintain operations.

**6.4** If more than thirty calendar days remain in the term, the special-election process shall begin within fifteen calendar days after the vacancy occurs and conclude within thirty calendar days. The interim officer serves until the special election is certified.

**6.5** If thirty calendar days or fewer remain in the term, the interim appointee may complete the term.

**6.6** An interim appointee or special-election candidate must satisfy the officer-eligibility and graduate-leadership requirements.

### Section 3: Presidential Succession

**6.7** When the presidency becomes vacant, the remaining Board shall appoint a graduate-student officer as Acting President until the special election is completed or the term ends.

**6.8** The Acting President has the duties and vote of the President but may not extend the acting appointment beyond the time allowed by this Article.

## Article VII: Ethics, Conflicts of Interest, and Accountability

### Section 1: Standards of Conduct

**7.1** Officers, committee members, and members acting for GSSA shall act honestly, respectfully, in good faith, and in the best interests of the organization.

**7.2** No person may misuse GSSA funds, records, accounts, confidential information, name, property, or authority for personal benefit.

### Section 2: Conflicts of Interest

**7.3** A person with a financial, personal, academic, supervisory, or other direct interest that could reasonably affect impartial judgment shall disclose the conflict before discussion or decision.

**7.4** A person with a conflict shall not develop criteria, review applications, deliberate, vote, approve payment, or otherwise influence the affected decision.

**7.5** The disclosure and recusal shall be recorded in the minutes or selection record.

### Section 3: Grounds and Process for Officer Removal

**7.6** Grounds for removal include:

(a) Serious misconduct or a substantial violation of University policy.

(b) Repeated failure to perform the responsibilities of office after written notice and a reasonable opportunity to improve.

(c) Misuse of funds, property, accounts, or confidential information.

(d) Falsification of records, election materials, reimbursement documents, or official communications.

(e) Three unexcused Executive Board meeting absences during the term.

**7.7** The officer shall receive written notice of the grounds and supporting information at least fourteen calendar days before the removal vote and shall have a reasonable opportunity to respond in writing and address the non-conflicted Executive Board officers before a decision is made.

**7.8** Anyone with a direct conflict of interest shall recuse. The officer whose removal is being considered may not preside over, administer, or count the vote and may not vote in the removal proceeding.

**7.9** The Faculty Advisor or another neutral University representative shall observe the process. Voting shall be confidential.

**7.10** Removal of an Executive Board officer shall require an affirmative vote of at least three non-conflicted Executive Board officers following consultation with the Faculty Advisor. The officer concerned shall not participate in the removal decision.

### Section 4: Temporary Protective Action

**7.11** When immediate action is reasonably necessary to protect GSSA funds, accounts, records, property, safety, or University compliance, at least three Executive Board officers may temporarily suspend an officer's financial or account access.

**7.12** Temporary protective action does not remove the officer and shall remain no broader or longer than reasonably necessary while the regular review or removal process proceeds.

## Article VIII: Finances, Property, and Limited Opportunities

### Section 1: Budget and Financial Records

**8.1** At the final Executive Board meeting of each semester, the Board shall approve a budget for the following semester. The Board may amend the budget when needed.

**8.2** All funds shall be held, spent, and reported through accounts and procedures authorized by Saint Louis University.

**8.3** The Vice President of Finance shall maintain complete records of income, expenses, receipts, reimbursements, approvals, sponsorships, and property.

### Section 2: Expense Approval

**8.4** The President and Vice President of Finance may jointly approve a budgeted expense of up to and including $250.

**8.5** An expense above $250 requires approval by a majority of the Executive Board with quorum.

**8.6** Every expense must be documented and reported at the next Executive Board meeting.

**8.7** No officer may approve a payment or reimbursement to themselves. A non-conflicted officer with appropriate authority must review and approve it.

**8.8** GSSA shall not incur unauthorized debt, open an independent financial account, or make a payment outside University procedures.

### Section 3: Sponsorships and Property

**8.9** The Executive Board may accept sponsorships, grants, donated services, or property when permitted by University policy and consistent with the GSSA mission.

**8.10** A sponsor or donor may not control GSSA membership, elections, officer appointments, academic content, or student-selection decisions.

**8.11** Equipment and other property acquired for GSSA belong to the organization or Saint Louis University as required by University policy, not to an individual officer or member.

### Section 4: Limited Opportunities

**8.12** When demand may exceed the available conference vouchers, registrations, memberships, travel assistance, awards, sponsored opportunities, or other limited benefits, GSSA shall use a fair and documented selection process.

**8.13** Before applications open, GSSA shall publish:

(a) Eligibility requirements and the available quantity or funding.

(b) The application method, deadline, and decision timeline.

(c) The selection criteria and any scoring method.

**8.14** An applicant may not help develop the criteria, review applications, score applicants, approve the selection, or hear an appeal related to that opportunity.

**8.15** Selection shall be conducted by at least three non-applicant reviewers. Reviewers will ordinarily be eligible Executive Board officers.

**8.16** If three eligible Board reviewers are unavailable, the Faculty Advisor, another faculty member, or a University staff member may serve as an impartial reviewer.

**8.17** Executive Board service does not create priority. An officer may apply only with complete recusal from the selection process.

**8.18** The Secretary shall retain the announcement, criteria, reviewer names, disclosed conflicts, scoring records, and final decision in accordance with University record requirements.

## Article IX: Records, Communications, and Digital Assets

### Section 1: Official Records

**9.1** Official GSSA records include the Constitution and Bylaws, membership and attendance records, approved minutes, motions, election results, financial records, committee records, reports, agreements, and major correspondence.

**9.2** Adopted governing documents, approved general-meeting minutes, aggregate election results, and semester financial summaries shall be reasonably accessible to Student Members.

**9.3** Records containing private student information, confidential applications, passwords, or protected University information shall be limited to those with a legitimate organizational need.

### Section 2: Official Communications

**9.4** Official communications shall be accurate, respectful, accessible, and consistent with approved GSSA positions and University requirements.

**9.5** No individual may present a personal opinion as an official GSSA position without Executive Board authorization.

### Section 3: Digital Accounts and Assets

**9.6** GSSA email accounts, websites, social media accounts, cloud storage, mailing lists, design files, photographs, logos, and related credentials are organizational assets.

**9.7** Official accounts shall use organization-controlled contact information and recovery methods whenever available. Credentials shall not remain solely under one individual's personal control.

**9.8** Outgoing officers shall transfer access to digital accounts and assets within one month after their terms end and shall not retain or use access after the transfer.

**9.9** The Executive Board may revoke access when an officer or member leaves a role, when access is no longer needed, or when protective action is authorized under Article VII.

## Article X: Operational Policies, Interpretation, and Review

### Section 1: Operational Policies

**10.1** The Executive Board may adopt written operational policies for matters such as event registration, reimbursement documentation, account access, records, communications, and committee procedures.

**10.2** An operational policy may not conflict with the Constitution or Bylaws, reduce a member right, change an election rule, or transfer a power reserved to Active Members.

### Section 2: Interpretation

**10.3** The Executive Board may resolve a question of interpretation after consulting the Faculty Advisor when appropriate.

**10.4** A Board interpretation may be reversed by a majority vote of Active Members with general-membership quorum.

### Section 3: Bylaw Amendments

**10.5** An Active Member or the Executive Board may propose an amendment to the Bylaws.

**10.6** The complete proposed amendment and its purpose must be distributed to Student Members at least fourteen calendar days before the vote. Members must have a reasonable opportunity to discuss it.

**10.7** A Bylaw amendment is adopted by two-thirds of valid votes cast with general-membership quorum.

**10.8** The Secretary shall record the adopted text, vote, certification date, and effective date.

**Section 4: Periodic Review**

**10.9** The Executive Board shall review the Constitution and Bylaws at least once every two academic years and recommend amendments when experience, organizational growth, or University requirements make revision necessary.

## Article XI: Founding Transition

**11.1** The Founding Executive Board identified through the July 2026 GSSA formation process may provisionally adopt the Constitution and Bylaws by a vote of at least three of the four founding officers.

**11.2** The Founding Executive Board shall serve through April 30, 2027, unless an officer resigns, is removed, or is replaced through the vacancy procedures.

**11.3** The first regular election shall occur in Spring 2027 for terms beginning May 1, 2027.

**11.4** During the first full academic semester, the Founding Executive Board shall establish the membership roster, hold at least one general membership meeting, explain the governing documents, and conduct the ratification vote.

**11.5** Before member ratification, a vacancy on the Founding Executive Board may be filled after an open call for interest by unanimous vote of the remaining founding officers who do not have a conflict of interest.

**11.6** If Active Members do not ratify the Constitution and Bylaws during the first full academic semester, the provisional documents remain effective only as needed to preserve records, protect assets, satisfy obligations, or conduct a renewed ratification process.